Year 9 Admission Assessment v3.1: assessor instructions

Version 3.1, October 2026. Use with `Y09/Y09_Student_Paper_v3.1`. Version 3.1 is version 2 with the third reading text (Part C) removed: the listening, writing, maths, science and interview are unchanged from version 2. The reading paper is now Parts A and B (16 marks) in the same time as before. Do not mix papers and instructions from different versions: the question numbers, marks and band guides differ.

Reusable: print once and keep in the assessor's folder. Do not write on these pages. Record each candidate's marks on their own **grading sheet** (`Y09_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`), reading on the **Reading front sheet** and the interview on the **Interview sheet**.

Who this is for. Students applying for **Year 9** (age 13 on 1 September). A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually **completed Grade 7 (初一)**; a student joining mid-year is partway through Grade 8. Ask the student and the family which grade and which textbooks they have used, because the order of topics differs between textbooks and regions. Background on Chinese school sequences, the English bands and the decision guide is in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`.

What it measures. The student's level of English in listening, reading, writing and speaking (bands A to E), their maths and science against the UK Year 8 curriculum (what a Year 9 student should know on entry), and, through the interview, who they are, their future plans and their suitability for the programme.

1. At a glance

Order	Task	Minutes	Who leads	Materials	Print
1	Welcome	2	Assessor		These instructions
2	Listening: Part A conversation (1 to 8), Part B academic talk (9 to 16) (16 marks)	about 15 (recording)	Assessor plays the recording, or reads the scripts (3.1)	Pages 2 to 5; pencil; the recording	Student paper; grading sheet
3	Reading paper: Parts A and B (16 marks)	15	Student alone	Pages 6 to 9	
4	Writing: one task from two (16 marks)	10	Student alone	Pages 10 to 11	
5	Break	5		Water	
6	Maths: A Fluency, B Word questions, C Applied problems (30 marks)	25	Student alone; you may read any question aloud	Pages 12 to 17; pencil, rubber, ruler; **scientific calculator in Section C only**; no protractor	
7	Science: 7 questions (10 marks)	8	Student alone; you may read any question aloud	Pages 18 to 21; no calculator	
8	Interview, opening with the Sentence Reading Screen at **Level 8**	15	Interviewer, 1:1	Sentence Reading Card; a plain card to cover sentences	Reading front sheet; Interview sheet
	Total	**about 95**		A clock; a scientific calculator for each student	Final mark sheet

Marks go on the **grading sheet** (listening, writing, maths and science), the **Reading front sheet** (reading) and the **Interview sheet** (speaking).

For each candidate:

- the Year 9 student paper, version 3.1;
- the grading sheet (`Y09/Y09_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`);
- the Reading front sheet (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`);
- the Interview sheet for Years 7 to 10 (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`);
- the parent conversation record (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`);
- the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`).

For the room (print once, laminate the cards):

- these instructions;
- the Interviewer guide (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`);
- `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`;
- the sentence reading card (`shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`; laminate it);
- the other equipment in the table above: a clock, a plain card to cover the sentences, and a scientific calculator for each student (with a pencil, rubber and ruler for each candidate).

The parent conversation (`forms/Parent_Conversation_Record`, about 15 minutes) can run at the same time with another member of staff. The written papers (tasks 2 to 7) can be taken in a small group with one invigilator; the interview is always 1:1.

Planning note. The recording takes about 15 minutes: both texts twice, one minute to read each set of questions and the time to finish. Allow 15 minutes for the listening in the timetable.

2. Before you start

Room and materials. Quiet, bright, a clock the student can see, the student paper face down, a pencil, rubber and ruler. Glasses or hearing aids if the student uses them. **Calculators:** one scientific calculator per student for maths **Section C only**. Keep calculators out of reach until the student reaches Section C (in a group, hand them out when you say "Section C"), and collect them before the science. A phone may not be used as a calculator.

Say (welcome): "Hello, I am [name]. Thank you for coming today. These activities help us get to know you, so that we can help you when you join us. Some questions are easy and some are hard. Nobody gets everything right, and that is fine. Do your best. If you do not know an answer, go on to the next question. In the English parts, I can only repeat the instructions. In maths and science, I can read any question to you. You can use a calculator only in the last part of the maths, Section C. Please write all your answers in English. Do you have any questions before we start?"

Pace of speech. Year 9 students may still be learning English: speak steadily, close to normal speech, about 175 words a minute, when you give instructions, read the listening scripts and read maths and science questions aloud. Use the same pace for every candidate, so that the results can be compared. The listening recording is paced the same way.

Access rules (the same in every year group)

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	**Maths and science**
Reading aloud	Read only what the script says. Do not read the reading texts or questions aloud, explain words or translate. Instructions may be repeated in English.	Any question may be read aloud in English, as often as the student asks. You may point to the picture.
Chinese	Not used by staff.	If a Chinese-speaking colleague is present and the student clearly cannot follow the English after it has been read aloud, the colleague may say the question **once** in Chinese. Write **L** in the margin. The mark still counts. Record the L questions on the grading sheet: they are evidence about English.
Answers	**In English only.** An answer in Chinese scores 0.	**In English only:** numbers, words, ticks, drawings and working all count. An answer or explanation in Chinese scores 0.

	English sections (listening, reading, writing, sentence reading)	Maths and science
Calculator	Not allowed.	Maths Section C only (a scientific calculator). Not allowed in maths Sections A and B or in science.
Not yet taught		If the student says they have not learnt a topic, write **NT** beside the question. It scores 0. List NT topics on the grading sheet.

Extra time, a reader or other arrangements for a known need are allowed: record them on the grading sheet.

Stopping rules

- The student may stop any section when they have done what they can. Say: "That is fine. Thank you. We will go on to the next part."
- **Listening:** read both parts to every student; in a group, never stop the reading for one student. Part B is meant to stretch. A student who found Part A very hard may sit quietly through Part B: say once, "It is fine to leave Part B."
- **Reading paper:** if the student cannot answer any of Part A after about 4 minutes, let them stop and record it on the Reading front sheet. Do not move them on to Part B.
- **Writing:** if the student has written nothing in English after 3 minutes, say once: "Write anything you can in English: a few words or sentences about yourself is fine." Then let them stop when they wish.
- **Maths and science:** encourage the student to look at every page, because later questions on different topics may be easier for them. Do not stop early unless the student is distressed.
- If a student becomes upset at any point, stop, take a break, and continue only if they are happy to. Record it on the grading sheet.

Keeping the student at ease. Smile, use the student's name, and keep your voice calm. Do not say "right" or "wrong" during the tasks; say "thank you" instead. Give a two-minute warning before the end of the reading paper, maths and science. A student who finishes early may check their work quietly. The version 2 listening and maths, kept in version 3.1, are harder at the top on purpose: tell the student before the maths that the last part is meant to be difficult.

3. English

3.1 Listening (about 15 minutes with the recording, 16 marks)

There are two parts. **Part A** (questions 1 to 8) is the version 1 listening, unchanged: an everyday conversation. **Part B** (questions 9 to 16) is new: a short academic talk at the level of a lesson for a fluent English speaker of 13 to 14. Each part is read twice.

Recording. A recording of this test is in `audio/v3.1/Y09/` (see its `READ_ME_FIRST.txt` for the tracks and timings). Play it instead of reading the script: every candidate then hears the same voices, pace and pauses. The script below is its transcript, and the live reading option if no recording can be played. Read live at the recording's pace, one reading of Part A takes about 2 minutes 12 seconds and of Part B about 2 minutes 55 seconds, with the pauses: use this to check your own pace. Do not pause the recording during a reading of the script. Play Part A and Part B as separate tracks if you may stop after Part A; otherwise the full track plays both.

Part A. Say: "Turn to the Listening page. There are two parts. First, Part A. You will hear two friends, Mei and Tom, talking about a science club trip. I will read it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 1 to 8." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Read the Part A script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Read it again.

Part B. Say: "Now turn to Part B. You will hear a scientist, Dr Lin, giving a short talk to a class about tea. I will read it two times. First, you have one minute to read questions 9 to 16. You can also finish Part A." Wait one minute. **Say:** "Now listen." Read the Part B script. Wait 10 seconds. **Say:** "Now listen again." Read it again. Then give the student one more minute to finish.

Read it twice at the steady pace in Section 2 (about 175 words a minute, close to normal speech). In Part A, say each speaker's name before their line, a little more quietly, both times. In Part B, read as a teacher gives a short lesson: clearly and with natural stress, but without slowing down for the numbers, the dates or the subject words. At

each [pause], stop for about 3 seconds. Do not slow down for key words, repeat lines or explain anything. Part A takes about 2 minutes per reading and Part B about 3 minutes per reading.

Script: Part A, planning the Saturday trip

Mei: Hi, Tom. Are you coming on the science club trip on Saturday?

Tom: Yes, I am. But I've lost the letter. Where are we going again?

Mei: To the Science and Technology Museum. The robot exhibition has finished, but there's a new exhibition about space. They've got a real rocket engine! [pause]

Tom: Cool. What time do we meet?

Mei: At half past eight, at the school gate. The coach leaves at a quarter to nine, so don't be late. [pause]

Tom: What's the weather going to be like?

Mei: Cloudy in the morning, and rain in the afternoon. Bring an umbrella. [pause]

Tom: Do I need to bring any money?

Mei: The museum ticket is free for students. Lunch in the museum café costs forty yuan, or you can bring a packed lunch. [pause]

Tom: I'll bring my own lunch. My grandma makes amazing dumplings.

Mei: Oh, and Mr Zhang says everyone must bring their student card. You can't get a free ticket without it. [pause]

Tom: OK. When do we get back?

Mei: At about five o'clock. [pause]

Tom: Five o'clock? That's a long day. I hope it doesn't rain too much.

Mei: Most of the day is inside, anyway. [pause]

Tom: Oh no, my student card! I think it's still in my PE bag. I'd better check tonight.

Mei: Good idea. Last time, Jun forgot his card, and he had to wait at the ticket office for twenty minutes while Mr Zhang phoned the school.

Tom: Poor Jun. I don't want that to happen to me. See you on Saturday! [pause]

Part A answers (1 mark each). Spelling does not matter in listening if the meaning is clear (for example "studen kard"). This applies to Part B too.

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
1	**A** (the rocket: space)		B (robots: the exhibition that has finished)
2	**B** (8:30)		A (8:45 is when the coach leaves)
3	**C** (rain)		B (cloudy is the morning)
4	**40** (yuan)	forty; ¥40	
5	**(their) student card**	student ID; school card; card	ticket; money; umbrella
6	**(about) five o'clock**	5; 5:00; 17:00; five; 5 pm	8:30 or 8:45
7	**The rain will not be a big problem.**		

Q	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
8	**To warn Tom, or to remind him why he must bring his card**	Any answer that shows what happened to Jun because he forgot his card (he had to wait 20 minutes), or that Mei does not want the same thing to happen to Tom	"Jun is her friend"; "Jun was late"; an answer about lunch or dumplings

Script: Part B, a short talk about tea (Dr Lin, a scientist, talking to a class)

Good morning, everyone. Today I want to answer two questions: where did tea come from, and why are there so many different kinds? [pause]

After water, tea is the most popular drink in the world, and its history begins in China. According to a famous legend, nearly five thousand years ago, the emperor Shennong was boiling water under a tree when a few leaves drifted into his pot, and he liked the taste. It's a charming story, and a very convenient one for an emperor. What historians can show for certain is much more recent. [pause] In the Tang dynasty, more than twelve hundred years ago, a scholar called Lu Yu wrote the first book entirely about tea, explaining how to grow, prepare and serve it. [pause]

From China, tea spread in two directions. Merchants carried it over land to Central Asia, Russia and the Middle East, while European ships later carried it by sea. Dutch traders brought the first tea to Europe in the early fifteen hundreds. Actually, no, I've got my dates wrong: it was the early sixteen hundreds, about a hundred years later. They bought it from merchants from Fujian, on China's south-east coast, and from the Netherlands it later reached Britain. [pause]

Now for the science. Surprisingly, green tea, black tea and oolong all come from exactly the same plant, an evergreen bush called Camellia sinensis. Pickers take only the top two leaves and the bud, which is the tiny leaf that hasn't opened yet. [pause]

The difference between the teas comes from a process called oxidation. When a leaf is crushed, chemicals inside it react with oxygen in the air, and the leaf gradually turns brown, just like a sliced apple. [pause] To make green tea, workers heat the leaves soon after picking, in a hot pan or with steam. The heat stops oxidation, so the leaves stay green and taste fresh. Black tea, on the other hand, is first withered, which means it is spread out until it goes soft. Next, it is rolled to break the leaves, then left in warm air until it is fully oxidised. Finally, it is dried. As a result, black tea is darker and stronger. Oolong, however, is only partly oxidised, so it sits somewhere in between. [pause]

One last puzzle: in Fujian, the local word for tea sounds like "te". Countries that received their tea by sea mostly use a word like "tea", whereas countries that received it over land say something like "cha" or "chai". So the name of your drink may tell you which way the tea travelled. [pause]

About the Part B script (for the English team). 427 words in 27 sentences: an average sentence of about 16 words. About 19% of the words are outside the 2000 most common word forms of English (about 13% if names are left out and simple word endings are matched, the method in `02_Listening_Evidence_Statement`, Section 6). It explains a process (oxidation and how black tea is made) and a cause and effect (heat stops oxidation, so green tea stays green); compares green, black and oolong tea, and the land and sea routes; uses numbers and dates; explains subject words in context (bud, oxidation, withered); implies an opinion (that the Shennong legend may not be true); corrects itself ("Actually, no, I've got my dates wrong"); and uses the discourse markers however, whereas, on the other hand and as a result.

Part B answers (1 mark each; questions 13 and 14 are one gap each). The questions follow the order of the talk.

Q	Skill	Answer	Also accept	Do not accept, and what it tells you
9	Main idea: the speaker's purpose	**To explain where tea came from and why there are different kinds.**		"To tell the story of the emperor Shennong" (one detail from the start: the student has not followed the whole talk). "To show that green tea is better than black tea" (the talk compares the teas but never says one is better).
10	Speaker's attitude (implied)	**It is a nice story, but it may not be true.**		"The best evidence we have" (the student took the legend as fact and missed "a very convenient one for an emperor" and "What historians can show for certain is much more recent"). "Historians have proved that it is wrong" (too strong: Dr Lin doubts it but does not say it has been disproved).
11	Specific detail: a number	**1200** (more than twelve hundred years ago)	twelve hundred; 1,200	5000 (the legend). 120 or 12 000 (the number was heard but not understood as "twelve hundred").
12	Specific detail: a date, after a correction	**1600s** (the early sixteen hundreds)	sixteen hundreds; the seventeenth century; 1600; about 1610	**1500s** or fifteen hundreds: the date Dr Lin corrects. The student heard the first date but not "Actually, no, I've got my dates wrong". This is the key error to note.
13	Note completion: a subject word explained in the talk	**(the) bud**	budd (any spelling that is clearly bud); "the tiny leaf"; "the leaf that has not opened"	leaf or leaves alone; flower; top; tea
14	Note completion: a subject word	**oxygen**	oxigen, oxgen (clearly oxygen); O_2	air (already in the sentence); oxidation; water; steam
15	Process: the order of steps	**Rolled 2, left in warm air 3, dried 4** (withered 1 is given)		All three numbers must be right for the mark. "Dried" before "left in warm air" shows that "Finally, it is dried" was missed.
16	Inference that joins two parts of the talk	**Tea came to Britain by sea** (Dutch ships brought it from Fujian merchants, and in Fujian the word sounds like "te"), and countries that got tea by sea use a word like "tea"	Any answer that links how tea reached Britain or England (by sea, by ship, from the Dutch, from Fujian) with the name: "Britain got it by sea"; "it came from Fujian, where they say te"; "the Dutch brought it from Fujian by ship"	"English people like tea"; "cha is a Chinese word"; "tea is easier to say". The rule alone ("countries that got tea by sea say tea") with nothing about how tea reached Britain: the link is the inference.

Band guide v2

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 2	**A** New to English
Part A 3 to 4	**B** Early acquisition
Part A 5 to 6, or Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 0 to 2	**C** Developing competence
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 3 to 5	**D** Competent
Part A 7 to 8 with Part B 6 to 8	**E** Fluent

Part A places bands A to C; Part B separates C, D and E. If the result is uneven (for example Part A 5 or 6 but Part B 3 or more), use judgement and check against listening in the interview.

What to look for

- **Part A.** Questions 1 to 3 check the main points, each with a distractor (robots, 8:45, cloudy); 4 to 6 need exact detail; 7 and 8 need implied meaning. A student who gets 1 to 6 but not 7 and 8 follows everyday talk but not yet what is meant. A wrong answer that is a distractor (8:45, B in question 3) shows the student heard words but not how they connect ("leaves at", "in the morning").
- **Part B.** Questions 11 to 15 need details, subject words and a sequence heard in a longer talk; questions 10 and 16 need what is implied or what joins two parts of the talk. A student who scores 3 to 5, with 10 and 16 wrong, follows the content of a lesson but not yet the speaker's meaning: usually D. Fluent listeners usually get the correction in question 12 and the inference in question 16.
- **Stamina.** A student who answers questions 9 to 12 well but leaves the later questions blank may have lost concentration in a three-minute talk, rather than not understood it: note it on the Reading front sheet, and check in the interview.
- Compare with listening in the interview (how much of your English the student understood). If the two differ by more than one band, use the interview as a check: some students freeze in a test, and some hide gaps in conversation with good routines.

3.2 Reading paper (15 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Reading page. There are two parts, A and B. Part B is harder. Read the texts yourself. I cannot read them to you or explain words. Do as much as you can. It is fine if you do not finish. You have 15 minutes." Give a two-minute warning.

General rules. Answers can be in the student's own words or copied from the text, unless the question says "in your own words". Ignore spelling and grammar unless the answer cannot be understood. Answers must be in English; an answer in Chinese scores 0.

What changed from version 1. Part A is the version 1 Part A (the poster). Part B is the version 1 Part C ("Halfway Up"), renumbered as questions 8 to 14. The version 1 Part B (pandas) is not used, and there is no Part C: the version 2 Part C memoir ("Before the Cranes Came") is not used in version 3.1.

Part A: sports centre poster (very accessible; picture support)

Q	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
1	Swimming	1	swim
2	¥15	1	15; 15 yuan
3	Yoga	1	
4	A swimming cap	1	cap; swim hat. Do not accept "money" or "student card".
5	False, True, True, False	2	All four correct: 2. Three correct: 1. Two or fewer: 0 (two is the score from guessing).
6	**No** and a reason: climbing is for ages 13 and over; he is too young; he is only 12	1	Both parts needed. "No" alone: 0.
7	Table tennis	1	Climbing is on Saturday afternoon, so "climbing" does not score.

Part B: "Halfway Up" (fiction, age-appropriate for a fluent reader of 13; version 1 Part C, questions renumbered)

Q	Skill	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
8	Retrieval	Eight metres	1	8 m; 8. Do not accept 2 metres (the training height).
9	Vocabulary and meaning in context	"Mei knew the move was easy, but she still felt afraid."	1	

Q	Skill	Answer	Marks	Also accept / notes
10	Retrieval and inference	Any **two** of: her arms shook; sweat made her fingers slippery; her breathing was fast and loud; she wanted to be lowered down or give up; "one terrible second"; she was "not so sure"; the coach's voice sounded far away; something tight in her chest	2	1 mark each, own words or quotation. Do not accept "she looked up" or "she was eight metres up" alone.
11	Author's purpose	To show the pressure on Mei: she does not want to be the only one who fails; she feels she must reach the top too	1	To make the reader worry that she will fail; to make her feel worse or more nervous. Do not accept a retelling with no purpose ("because they reached the top").
12	Inference	The sign was funny or sweet (her little brother made it; "MEI CAN FLY"), and it made her feel better	1	Either idea: it was funny or cute; her brother's support cheered her up or made her less nervous. Do not accept "she was happy" with no reason.
13	Vocabulary in context	It suddenly became very loud; everyone started cheering at once	1	very loud; suddenly noisy; people shouted and clapped. Do not accept a literal explosion or "something broke".
14	Inference across the text	From frightened or nervous (start) to happy, proud, relieved or confident (end)	1	Both ends needed.

Band guide (version 3.1; use judgement when a result is uneven, and check against the sentence reading screen)

Result	Band
Part A 0 to 3	**A** New to English
Part A 4 or more, Part B 0 to 2	**B** Early acquisition
Part B 3 to 5	**C** Developing competence
Part B 6 to 8	**D** Competent, or **E** Fluent (see below)

D or E. Part B is the age-level text, so 6 or more shows at least a competent reader. Give **E** only when Part B is 7 or 8 **and** the sentence reading screen (meaning checks and fluency) and the writing also point to E. Version 3.1 has no text above age level, so the reading paper alone cannot confirm band E.

Record the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes on the **Reading front sheet**, and give it to the interviewer.

What to look for

- **Part B** ("Halfway Up") is the age-appropriate text: 6 or more shows a competent reader of age-level fiction. There is no text above the age-expected level, so decide between D and E with the sentence reading screen and the writing (see the band guide).
- **An English barrier** looks like: Part A secure, Part B patchy, blank or copied lines that do not answer the question. A student who reads aloud well (sentence reading) but scores low on Part B may be decoding without understanding: see the meaning checks on the Reading front sheet.
- **Speed.** Note where the student was when time ran out, on the Reading front sheet. A student who answers everything they reach correctly but does not finish Part B may be a slow but accurate reader: give a band by judgement and say so.

3.3 Writing (10 minutes, 16 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Writing page. Choose one task, A or B, and tick the box. You can plan in the box, then write on the lines. You have 10 minutes. Write as much as you can." Do not explain the tasks or words.

The tasks. Task A (narrative): a story that begins "When I opened my bag, I found something that was not mine." Task B (opinion): an article for the school magazine, "Should every school day include one hour of sport?", with an opinion and at least two reasons. The plan is not marked.

Score each criterion 0 to 4 (1 and 3 fall between the descriptions).

Criterion	0	2	4 (what a fluent 13 year old would do)
Content and organisation	Nothing relevant in English, or a few words copied from the task.	Relevant to the task; ideas in a sensible order but little developed; may be one block of text; the story stops rather than ends, or the article lists reasons without explaining them.	Well developed and clearly organised in paragraphs. Story: an opening that follows on from the given sentence, a problem, some description or tension, an ending. Article: a clear opinion, two or more reasons with examples or explanation, a conclusion; suits a magazine reader.
Vocabulary	Isolated words, or only words from the prompt.	Everyday words used correctly but repeated ("good", "very", "nice"); a few words chosen for effect; simple linking (and, but, because).	Wide and precise vocabulary, some ambitious words used correctly; a range of linking words (however, although, as a result, suddenly); topic words (fitness, stress, concentrate).
Grammar and sentences	No sentences.	Mostly simple sentences, some joined with and, but, because; frequent errors in verb tense, plurals and articles, but the meaning is clear.	A variety of sentence types, including complex sentences (when, although, which, if); tenses controlled (past tense in the story); errors are rare and do not affect meaning.
Spelling and punctuation	Mostly impossible to read.	Common words spelt correctly; capital letters and full stops mostly correct; errors in less common words.	Almost all words spelt correctly, including ambitious ones; full stops, commas, question marks, apostrophes and (in a story) speech marks used correctly.

Band by best fit, using the descriptors in `00_Admissions_Guide.md`, Section 6, and the notes below. The total is a check, not a rule: as a rough guide, totals of 0 to 3 usually go with A, 4 to 7 with B, 8 to 10 with C, 11 to 13 with D and 14 to 16 with E.

Band	Writing at Year 9 entry
A	Name, isolated words or copied phrases; may write in Chinese.
B	A few short sentences on the topic, with frequent errors; meaning mostly clear.
C	A short connected piece (often 60 to 120 words) with some joined sentences; errors frequent but rarely block meaning; little paragraphing.
D	An organised piece (often 120 to 200 words) with paragraphs and a range of sentences; generally accurate with occasional errors; some varied vocabulary.
E	See below.

Band E writing at this age. A fluent 13 year old usually writes 150 to 250 words in 10 minutes, in paragraphs, with a clear opening and ending, a range of sentence types used for effect, controlled tenses, precise and sometimes ambitious vocabulary, and mostly accurate spelling and punctuation. The story has a voice and some suspense; the article sounds like an article (it speaks to the reader, gives reasons and examples, and ends with a conclusion).

What to look for

- Typical features of English from speakers of Chinese (missing articles, plural -s, past tense -ed, third person -s) are normal at bands C and D. Do not let them alone pull a well-organised, well-developed piece below D.
- A memorised opening ("Once upon a time", "Nowadays, with the development of society") followed by very simple writing shows exam training more than fluency: band by what the student can produce independently.
- A student who plans well (clear notes in the plan box) but writes little may have the ideas but not yet the English: note it in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet, because it points to good progress with support.

3.4 Interview, speaking and sentence reading (15 minutes, 1:1)

The questions and the speaking band descriptors are in the **Interviewer guide** (`forms/Interviewer_Guide_Y7_Y10`), and the record is the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`). The sentence reading rules are in `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide`, the student reads from `shared/Sentence_Reading_Card`, and the results go on the **Reading front sheet**. All are in English.

- **Sentence reading first** (3 to 5 minutes). Year 9 starts at **Level 8 (sentence 22)**. Follow the start, going-back and stopping rules and the scoring in the guide. It gives total points out of 72, an indicative reading age, meaning checks and a fluency rating, which you record on the Reading front sheet. If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1.
- **Interview** (about 10 minutes): choose questions from each block in the Interviewer guide, including **future plans and aspirations** and the suitability strands. Use the easier and stretch prompts so that every student can show their best spoken English. Ask the questions at the pace in Section 2 (about 175 words a minute), the same for every candidate.
- **Speaking band:** give it using the descriptors in the Interviewer guide, and record it on the Interview sheet. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

4. Maths (25 minutes, 30 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Maths page. You have 25 minutes. There are three sections. In Sections A and B, you may not use a calculator. In Section C, you may use a calculator. Write your answers in the boxes and show your working. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can, and look at every page. Section C is meant to be hard." Give the calculator only when the student reaches Section C. Give a two-minute warning.

The example box at the start of Section A shows what the command words mean (simplify, expand, factorise, standard form, make *x* the subject), and the example at the start of Section B shows how to write an equation from words. They are there so that an English word does not hide maths the student knows.

Sections. There are no floor questions: every question is at or above the expected level for entry to Year 9.

- **Section A, Fluency** (questions 1 to 6, 10 marks): calculation and algebra with no context; **no calculator**. It starts at the top of the Year 8 expected content (index laws, standard form) and goes into early Year 9 (negative indices, double brackets, factorising quadratics, simultaneous equations, rearranging).
- **Section B, Word questions** (questions 7 to 10, 8 marks): problems given only in words, with no diagram; **no calculator**. The student must decide what to do and usually form an equation (direct proportion, a reverse percentage, simultaneous equations from a context, a quadratic from an area).
- **Section C, Applied problems** (questions 11 to 15, 12 marks): multi-step problems in real contexts with a picture, a table, a graph or a diagram; **a scientific calculator is allowed**. Best value, simple and compound interest, a real-life graph (what the gradient means), a cylinder with a flow rate, and Pythagoras with a ratio. Question 13(b) is an **Explain** question; question 15 is a **Show that** question in an unfamiliar context (how TV screens are measured).

Marking. M = method mark, A = accuracy mark (depends on the method), B = independent mark, ft = follow through (allow the mark for correct work with the student's own earlier wrong value). A correct answer with no working gets full marks, except in questions 11, 12 and 15, where the working is part of the answer. Units are not needed unless stated. Working in numbers and symbols is fine; any words must be in English (an explanation in Chinese scores 0).

Calculators. Many Chinese middle schools do not allow calculators, so some students are slow with one. A calculator is allowed in Section C, not required: every Section C question can be done by hand (with π = 3.14 in question 14). Do not count it against a student who works by hand.

What a Year 9 entrant may not have been taught. A student from a Chinese mainstream school has usually completed **Grade 7 (初一)**: operations with negative numbers, algebraic expressions, linear equations, simultaneous linear equations, linear inequalities, angles and parallel lines, square roots and coordinates. **Linear and simultaneous equations and inequalities are usually strong.** Grade 8 (初二) topics **may not have been taught yet**: zero and negative indices, multiplying out double brackets, factorising, Pythagoras' theorem and linear functions (gradient). Quadratic equations are Grade 9 (初三). Textbooks differ: 北师大版 teaches index laws and multiplying polynomials in the second term of Grade 7, 人教版 in Grade 8, so ask which book the student used. Use NT and judge whether the student would reach the expected band once taught.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
Section A: Fluency (no calculator)				
1	Negative index; power of a product	(a) 1/8 (b) $4x^6$	(a) B1. Accept 0.125. −8 or −6 score 0 (the negative power read as "minus"): note it. (b) B1. $2x^6$ (only x^3 squared) or $4x^5$ (indices added) score 0: note it.	(a) Negative indices are Grade 8 (负整数指数幂): may not have been taught. (b) Powers of products (积的乘方) are Grade 8 in 人教版, Grade 7 in 北师大版: may not have been taught.
2	Standard form calculation with a negative power	1.5×10^{-2}	M1 for 15×10^{-3} or 0.015 seen; A1 for 1.5×10^{-2}. 15×10^{-3} as the final answer: M1 only (not standard form). 1.5×10^{-3} with no correct working: 0.	Standard form for large numbers is Grade 7 (科学记数法); with negative powers it is Grade 8: may not have been taught.
3	Expanding double brackets	$2x^2 + 5x - 12$	M1 for at least three of the four terms $2x^2$, $+8x$, $-3x$, -12; A1 for the simplified answer.	Multiplying polynomials (多项式乘多项式) is Grade 8 in 人教版, Grade 7 in 北师大版: may not have been taught. Single brackets are secure.
4	Factorising a quadratic	$(x - 5)(x + 3)$	B1, either order. $(x + 5)(x - 3)$ scores 0 (it expands to $x^2 + 2x - 15$): note "sign error".	Factorising a trinomial (十字相乘法) is often taught only with quadratic equations in Grade 9, or as enrichment: may not have been taught.
5	Simultaneous equations (a multiplier is needed)	$x = 2$, $y = 1$	M1 for a correct method to eliminate one letter (for example $4x + 6y = 14$ and $15x - 6y = 24$, so $19x = 38$), or a correct substitution; A1 for both values.	Usually secure (Grade 7, 二元一次方程组). A student from a Chinese school who loses these marks is weaker in algebra than the rest of the profile may suggest.
6	Rearranging a formula	$x = (5y + 2)/3$	B1. Accept $5y/3 + 2/3$, $(2 + 5y) \div 3$ or any equivalent. A part-way step ($5y = 3x - 2$, or $3x = 5y + 2$) does not score: note it.	The algebra is Grade 7 (等式的性质) and usually secure; the English "make x the subject" may be new, which is why the example box explains it.
Section B: Word questions (no calculator)				
7	Direct proportion: a rate	15 minutes	M1 for 14 pages per minute, or $210 \div 84 = 2.5$ (then × 6), or $6 \div 84$ minutes per page; A1 for 15.	Secure (Grade 6, 正比例).
8	Reverse percentage	¥120	M1 for $96 \div 0.8$, or $96 \div 80 \times 100$, or $0.8x = 96$, or 80% = ¥96; A1 for 120. An answer of 115.20 (96×1.2, adding 20% back on) scores 0: note it. It is the most common error, and shows the reverse step is not understood.	Usually secure: discounts (打折, "八折") and finding the original price are common in Grade 6 and in Grade 7 equation problems.
9	Simultaneous equations from a context	One pen ¥4, one notebook ¥7	M1 for two correct equations ($3p + 2n = 26$ and $p + 4n = 32$, any letters) or a systematic trial that uses both facts; A1 for both values.	The maths is secure (Grade 7); the test is forming the equations from English sentences.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
10	Forming and solving a quadratic from an area	Equation $w(w + 3) = 40$ (or $w^2 + 3w - 40 = 0$); width **5 cm**	B1 for a correct equation in w. B1 for 5, from factorising ($(w + 8)(w - 5) = 0$) or from trying values ($5 \times 8 = 40$). If both 5 and −8 are given as the width, the second mark needs −8 to be rejected.	Quadratic equations are Grade 9 (一元二次方程): may not have been taught. The width can be found by trying values, so a strong student can still score both marks.
Section C: Applied problems (calculator allowed)				
11	Best value: unit price	The **2.5 kg** bag	M1 for at least two correct values that can be compared: price per kg (¥13.80, ¥13.00, ¥13.20), or kg per yuan (0.0725, 0.0769, 0.0758), or the price of the same mass (for 5 kg: ¥69, ¥65, ¥66); A1 for 2.5 kg with all three compared correctly. The tick alone, with no working, scores 0.	Secure (unit price, 单价, Grades 4 to 6). Many students expect the biggest bag to be the best value; here it is not.
12	Simple and compound interest	**Account A** (¥5600, against ¥5540.63 in Account B)	M1 for a correct compound interest method for Account B: 5000×1.026^4, or year by year 5130, 5263.38, 5400.23, 5540.63 (5540.64 if each year is rounded to 2 decimal places), or ¥540.63 interest. A1 for both amounts correct (A ¥5600 or ¥600 interest; B ¥5540.63, accept ¥5540.64, ¥5540.6 or ¥5541) and Account A chosen. Account A worked out on its own scores 0 (simple interest is the familiar part). Simple interest at 2.6% for B (¥5520) shows the table was not read: 0, even with Account A ticked. Compound interest at 3% for A (¥5627.54) with B correct: M1 A0.	Simple interest is Grade 6 (利率). Compound interest is usually met only in Grade 9 (增长率, $(1 + x)^2$) or later: may not have been taught. The table explains how each account works, so a careful reader can work year by year.
13	Real-life straight-line graph: the gradient and what it means	(a) **15** (b) The cost goes up by **¥15 for each extra hour** (the hire charge is ¥15 per hour)	(a) B1. Accept 15 yuan per hour. (b) B1 for an explanation in context: per hour, with a value (ft their (a)). "The line goes up" or "it is steep" scores 0. "The fixed fee is ¥10" is the intercept, not the gradient: 0 for (b), but it shows the graph was read.	Linear functions and gradient are Grade 8 (一次函数): may not have been taught. A student who does not know the English word "gradient" may still explain the cost per hour: mark (b) on its own.
14	Volume of a cylinder; units; a rate	**40 minutes**	M1 for the volume $\pi \times 40^2 \times 120$ (603 186 cm³, or 0.603 m³, or 603 litres); M1 for dividing by 1000 and by 15, or equivalent (ft their volume); A1 for 40. Accept 40.2. $\pi = 3.14$ gives 40.19: accept 40. Using 80 as the radius gives about 161: M0 M1 A0, note "diameter used as radius".	Cylinder volume is Grade 6 (圆柱的体积) and litres and cm³ Grade 5: usually secure. Errors are usually the radius or the unit conversion.
15	Pythagoras with a ratio: **Show that**, unfamiliar context	Width $= 16 \times 140 \div \sqrt{337} =$ **122.02** cm, which is about 122 cm	M1 for using Pythagoras with the ratio: $(16k)^2 + (9k)^2 = 140^2$, or $337k^2 = 19\,600$, or the diagonal of a 16 by 9 rectangle is $\sqrt{337} = 18.36$, or $w^2 + (9w/16)^2 = 140^2$; M1 for $k = 7.626$ (or the scale factor $140 \div 18.36$, or $w^2 = 14\,889$); A1 for 122.0 or 122.02 seen (more accurate than 122; 122.1 from k rounded to 7.63 is fine). A complete check that starts from 122 (height $122 \times 9 \div 16 = 68.6$, and $\sqrt{(122^2 + 68.6^2)} = 140.0$) with a conclusion also scores 3. "122" with no working scores 0. Sharing 140 in the ratio 16 : 9 (89.6 cm) scores 0: note it.	Pythagoras' theorem is Grade 8 (勾股定理): may not have been taught. Ratio is secure (Grade 6). This is a ceiling question for the strongest students.

Totals: Fluency (Section A) / 10; Word questions (Section B) / 8; Applied problems (Section C) / 12; total / 30.

Band guide v2 (provisional, for a harder paper): 0 to 10 (under 35%): **1** Below expected; 11 to 16 (35 to 54%): **2** Working towards; 17 to 22 (55 to 74%): **3** Expected; 23 to 30 (75% or more): **4** Greater depth, likely top set. Look at the NT questions before deciding.

Reading the three sub-scores

As a rough guide, "high" is about three quarters of a section or more, and "low" is under half.

Profile	What it usually means	What to do
High Fluency, low Word questions	The English of the questions, not the maths, is the barrier.	Read one or two of the word questions aloud in English, then, if a Chinese-speaking colleague is present, once in Chinese (mark L). If the student then solves them quickly, record an English barrier on the grading sheet: it points to English support in maths lessons, not to a lower maths set.
High Fluency and Word questions, low Applied	Secure content, but less practised at multi-step problems, choosing a method and explaining.	The student needs teaching in problem solving and explaining, not more content. It is not a reason for a lower set.
Low Fluency	Gaps in calculation and algebra, or several NT topics.	Check the NT notes: if most of the lost marks are NT questions (questions 1 to 4), write the likely band once taught in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.
Applied as high as, or higher than, Fluency	Good reasoning with some gaps in technique or untaught algebra.	Usually NT topics in Section A; check before placing lower.

Not tested this year (not enough time): scatter graphs, two-way tables and tree diagrams, bearings, similar shapes, depreciation, inequalities. Ask about them in the interview if they matter for placement.

What to look for

- **Word questions.** A student who defines letters and writes equations ("Let *p* be the cost of a pen") is ready for English-medium maths. A student who writes only numbers but gets the answers has the maths; check in the interview whether they can explain a method in English.
- **Applied problems.** Look at whether the student chooses a method without being told (unit price, year-by-year interest, volume then litres, Pythagoras with a ratio). The Explain in 13(b) and the Show that in 15 show whether the student can communicate maths in English. Many students from Chinese schools calculate quickly and accurately but leave out working: that is a habit, not a weakness, but in a Show that question the working is the answer.
- **Weak responses** show errors on taught topics (simultaneous equations, percentages, unit price, cylinder volume), not just on NT topics. If most of the lost marks are NT questions, write the likely band once taught in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.

5. Science (8 minutes, 10 marks)

Say: "Turn to the Science page. You have 8 minutes. I can read any question to you in English. Do as much as you can."

What a Year 9 entrant may not have been taught. In Chinese middle schools, biology starts in Grade 7 (cells, plants, the human body, digestion, breathing, food chains), physics in Grade 8 and chemistry only in Grade 9. A Year 9 entrant has usually done **some biology but no secondary physics or chemistry**. Questions 4 to 6 may not have been taught: mark NT rather than reading this as weak science, and judge the student's scientific thinking from questions 5 and 7.

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
1	Food webs	(a) grass (b) "It goes up" **and** fewer frogs eat them	(a) B1. (b) B1 for the tick with a correct reason; the tick alone scores 0.	Secure (Grade 7 biology, 食物网).

Q	Topic	Answer	Marks and partial credit	May not have been taught?
2	Photosynthesis word equation	oxygen	B1. Accept O_2.	Secure (Grade 7 biology), but the English words "glucose" and "carbon dioxide" may be new: read them aloud.
3	Digestion	C (small intestine)	B1	Secure (Grade 7 biology, 消化和吸收).
4	Elements, compounds and mixtures	(a) B (b) C	B1 each	Chemistry is Grade 9: may not have been taught.
5	Conservation of mass	150.0 g	B1. Accept 150.	Grade 9 chemistry (质量守恒定律): may not have been taught, but a good scientific thinker can reason it from "nothing can get in or out".
6	Current in a series circuit	0.3 A	B1	Series circuits are Grade 9 physics: may not have been taught; simple circuits are met in primary.
7	Electromagnet: fair test and pattern in a table	(a) One control variable: the same battery (or voltage), the same nail, the same kind of paper clips, the same wire (b) 12	B1 each. (a) Do not accept "number of turns" (the variable he changes) or "number of paper clips" (what he measures).	Electromagnets are met in some primary textbooks and in Grade 9 physics; the working scientifically skills are the main point.

Band guide (provisional): 0 to 3: **1**; 4 to 5: **2**; 6 to 8: **3**; 9 to 10: **4**. Look at the NT questions before deciding.

Not tested this year (not enough time): metals and non-metals in the periodic table, combustion and word equations, aerobic respiration, heating and cooling (conduction, convection, radiation).

What to look for

- **Working scientifically** (questions 5 and 7): a student who explains a fair test and spots the pattern in a table is likely to do well once taught, even with several NT questions.
- **An English barrier** looks like: blank or wrong answers that become right when you read the question aloud. Science vocabulary in English (producer, compound, mixture, ammeter) is often the gap: note the words the student did not know in the assessor's comment on the grading sheet.
- **Strong responses** give the reason as well as the answer in question 1(b) and name a sensible control variable in question 7(a).

6. Recording the results

1. **Mark the student paper.** Every question has a mark box.
2. **Copy the totals onto the grading sheet** (`Y09_Grading_Sheet_v3.1`) and give the bands from the band guides above (the grading sheet repeats them at a glance). Record there too the maths sub-scores and profile (Section 4), the NT topics and L questions, the writing task chosen (A or B), any access arrangements and your comment.
3. **Record the reading results and band on the Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`): the reading paper marks (Part A, Part B), the band and the question where the student stopped at 15 minutes.
4. **Give the interviewer the Reading front sheet and the Interview sheet** before the interview.
5. **After the interview, put together** the grading sheet, Reading front sheet, Interview sheet and parent conversation record, and complete the final mark sheet (`forms/Candidate_Summary_and_Decision`) within two working days. Write "v3.1" beside the scores on it: the listening is out of 16 (as in version 2), the reading paper is out of 16 (Parts A and B only) and the maths has three sub-scores. The overall English band is the band most skills sit in: name any skill that is two or more bands lower.
6. **File the marked student paper with them** (or shred it under the school's policy).

Interviewer guide: Years 7 to 10

This guide is reusable. Nothing is written on it: keep one in the room, in a folder or laminated. Ratings and notes for each student go on the **Interview sheet** (`forms/Interview_Sheet_Y7_Y10`).

About 15 minutes, 1:1. The interview is held **in English**. It has three jobs: to hear the student's spoken English (the speaking band), to get to know the student (interests, learning, wellbeing, **future plans and aspirations**), and to judge their **suitability** for the international programme. It opens with the Graded Sentence Reading Screen (3 to 5 minutes; start Level 6 for Year 7, 7 for Year 8, 8 for Year 9, 9 for Year 10; follow `shared/Sentence_Reading_Guide` and write the points on the Reading front sheet, `forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

How to ask. Start with the main question. If the student struggles, use the **easier** prompt (a yes or no, or a choice). If they answer easily, use the **stretch** prompt. This lets every student show their best English. Wait at least five seconds before rephrasing. Answers must be in English.

Pace of speech. Speak at a steady, clear pace: about 160 to 185 words a minute (Year 7 about 160, Year 8 about 160, Year 9 about 175, Year 10 about 185). Use the same pace for every candidate in the year group, and use it for the instructions and meaning questions of the sentence reading too. Do not rush: wait at least five seconds before rephrasing.

Safeguarding. Keep the door open or another adult present. If a student tells you something that worries you about their safety or wellbeing, do not promise to keep it secret; listen, write down their words, and pass it to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day.

1. Questions (10 minutes)

Choose about two questions from each block. On the Interview sheet, write short notes under "Key things the student said": what they said, and how they said it.

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
Warm-up	Tell me a little about yourself.	What is your name? How old are you? Where do you live?	What would your friends say about you?
	How did you travel here today?	Did you come by car?	What do you like or dislike about your city?
School and learning	Tell me about your school now.	Do you like your school? What is your favourite subject?	What is the biggest difference you expect between your school and ours?
	Which subject do you find hardest? What do you do when work is difficult?	Is maths easy or hard for you?	Tell me about a time you kept going when something was hard.
	How do you learn English now?	Do you have English lessons? Do you read in English?	What helps you most when you learn new words?
	How do you feel about learning all your subjects in English?	Are you worried, excited, or both?	What will be hardest, and how will you deal with it?
Interests	What do you enjoy doing outside school?	Do you like sport, music or art?	What have you achieved in it that you are proud of?
	Tell me about a book, film or game you enjoyed.	Do you like reading? What kind of books?	Why did it stay in your mind?
	Do you take part in any clubs, competitions, volunteering or service?	Do you help at home or in your community?	What did you learn from it?
Friends and wellbeing	Who do you spend time with at school?	Do you have good friends?	How do you help a friend who is having a bad day?

Block	Main question	Easier	Stretch
	How do you relax when you feel tired or stressed?	What makes you happy?	How do you balance study, activities and rest?
	How many classes or tutoring sessions do you have after school?	Do you have classes at the weekend?	How do you feel about how busy you are?
Future plans and aspirations	What would you like to do in the future?	Do you have a dream job?	What steps would get you there?
	Where would you like to study after school, and what would you study?	China or another country?	Why does that place or subject interest you?
	Why do you want to join the international programme? Whose idea was it?	Is it your idea or your parents' idea?	What do you hope it will give you that your school now does not?
	What kind of person do you want to be at our school?	Do you want to join clubs?	What could you give to our school community?
Values (choose one)	A classmate asks to copy your homework. What do you do?	Is it OK to copy homework?	Why does honesty matter in learning?
	A new student is sitting alone at lunch. What do you do?	Would you talk to them?	Why might someone find it hard to join a group?
Opinion (to hear extended speaking)	Should students have homework every day? Why, or why not?	Do you like homework?	What would be a better system? Give an example.
	Should phones be allowed in school?	Do you use a phone at school now?	What are the strongest arguments on the other side?
Year 10 only	Which IGCSE subjects would you like to take, and why?	Which subjects do you like best?	How do they connect to your future plans?
	The IGCSE course takes two years. How will you manage starting a new course in English?	Will it be hard for you?	What support will you look for, and from whom?
Questions for us	What would you like to ask me about the school?	Do you have any questions?	

2. Speaking band

Choose the band that fits best, using the evidence from the whole interview, and tick it on the Interview sheet. Rate **listening in conversation** (how much of your English they understood) with the same letters. Pronunciation features of a speaker of Chinese do not lower the band if the student is easy to understand.

Band	What you hear
A New to English	Little or no spoken English, or single memorised words and phrases ("I am fine"). Relies on Chinese, gesture or silence. Understands very little unless supported.
B Early acquisition	Short answers and simple memorised sentences on familiar topics (family, school, likes). Frequent errors in word order, verbs and plurals. Needs the easier prompts. Understands slow, simple questions.
C Developing competence	Answers most main questions with connected sentences, using "because", "but", "so". Errors are frequent but meaning is usually clear. Vocabulary is everyday; searches for words on less familiar topics. Can give a short opinion with a reason.
D Competent	Speaks at length on most questions, explains and gives examples, handles the stretch prompts with some effort. Errors are occasional and rarely affect meaning. Some subject and abstract vocabulary.
E Fluent	Speaks as fluently and accurately as a fluent English speaker of the same age. Handles abstract and hypothetical questions easily, with a wide vocabulary.

3. Suitability

Rate each strand on the Interview sheet from what you saw and heard: **1** Concern, **2** Some concern, **3** Good, **4** Strong. Write the evidence: a short quotation or something you observed.

Strand	What strong looks like
Attitude to learning and resilience	Wants to learn, has a go, keeps going when work is hard, talks about effort and improvement
Curiosity and engagement	Asks questions, shows interest in ideas beyond the textbook, enjoys discussion
Social and emotional readiness	Relaxed or able to settle, makes eye contact (allowing for culture and shyness), talks about friends, manages feelings, ready for a change of school
Independence and self-management	Organises themselves, can describe how they study, manages time and activities, will ask for help
Values and conduct	Kind, honest and respectful in the interview and in the values question
Readiness for English-medium learning	Motivated to learn in English, willing to speak even with mistakes, has strategies for new words
Clarity and ownership of future plans	Has thought about what comes next, the plans are their own as well as the family's, understands why the international programme fits

Boarding readiness (only if the student will board): independence with daily routines, sleep, homesickness, experience of being away from home. Rate it on the Interview sheet in the same way.

4. Anything to follow up

Tick any that apply on the Interview sheet, and add a note:

- Possible special educational need or disability (for example reading, attention, speech, hearing, vision)
- Wellbeing (for example anxiety, low mood, very heavy workload, sleep)
- Safeguarding (passed to the Designated Safeguarding Lead the same day)
- Medical or dietary
- Mismatch between the student's wishes and the family's plans

Receiving homeroom teacher (optional). If the student's likely homeroom teacher meets them, they note first impressions and what the student would need in the first weeks (for example a buddy who speaks Chinese, a vocabulary book for each subject, a quiet check-in each morning) on the Interview sheet.

To finish. On the Interview sheet, write your comment for the final mark sheet (strengths, concerns, support), and sign and date it.

Graded Sentence Reading Screen: interviewer guide

What it is. A quick 1:1 read-aloud screen for every candidate from Year 1 to Year 10. The student reads sentences that get harder, from a reading age of about 5 to adult level, until they can no longer read them. It gives an **indicative reading age**, an accuracy profile, a **fluency** rating and an **understanding** check. It takes 2 to 6 minutes. In Years 1 to 3 it follows the Early Reading Screen; from Year 4 it opens the interview.

You need: the student card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`), this guide (the sentences are in Section 5), the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`), a pencil, and a plain card or sheet of paper to cover the sentences the student has not reached yet (this stops a page of text looking frightening). This guide is reusable: nothing is written on it. Write every point, meaning mark, total and result on the Reading front sheet.

1. Start, carry on, stop

Year applied for	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Start at level	1	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
First sentence	1	1	4	7	10	13	16	19	22	25

- If you already know the student is new to English, start at Level 1 whatever their age.
- **Going back (basal).** If the student scores 6 out of 6 on the start level, give full credit (6 points) for every level below it. If they score less than 6, go back one level at a time until they score 6 out of 6 on a level (or you reach Level 1). Then carry on upwards from the level after the start level.
- **Stopping (ceiling).** Always finish the start level. Then stop at the end of any level where the student scores **2 points or fewer**. Stop straight away if the student scores 0 on **three sentences in a row**, or if they become upset. Levels above the stopping point score 0.

Say: "I would like you to read some sentences out loud for me. They start easy and get harder. When they get too hard, that is fine, we will stop. If you do not know a word, have a go. Ready?" Point to the first sentence. You may say "Have a go" or "Try the next word". Do not sound out, explain or translate any word.

Pace of speech. When you give the instructions and ask the meaning questions, speak slowly and clearly, especially with the younger students. Aim for about 120 words a minute in Years 1 and 2, 120 in Year 3, 130 in Year 4, 140 in Year 5, 155 in Year 6, 160 in Year 7, 160 in Year 8, 175 in Year 9 and 185 in Year 10. Use the same pace for every candidate in a year group, and do not rush.

2. Scoring each sentence

Errors in the sentence	Points
none (self-corrections are fine)	**2**
one	**1**
two or more	**0**

These count as one error each

Code	Error	Example
S	**Substitution**: says a different word or a non-word	"horse" for house; "sur-pried" for surprised
O	**Omission**: leaves out a word, or leaves off a written ending that changes the word (-s, -ed, -ing, -ly)	"The frog jump out" for jumped
I	**Insertion**: adds a word that is not there	"the a red bus"
T	**Told**: no attempt after about 5 seconds; say the word, mark T	
	Two words read in the wrong order	one error

These are not errors (do not count them)

Code	What happens	Why it is not an error
SC	**Self-correction**: reads a word wrongly, then puts it right	The student is checking meaning.
R	**Repetition** of a word or phrase	
	Pauses, or sounding out and then blending the word correctly	Note it for fluency instead.
	Accent and pronunciation features common for speakers of Chinese, when the word is still clearly the right word: l and r ("lice" for rice), n and l, v and w, th as s, f, d or z ("sink" for think), a light or missing final consonant sound, an extra vowel after a final consonant ("bed-uh"), the -ed ending said in full ("jump-ed"), stress on a different syllable ("ho-TEL", "PHO-to-graph")	These are features of a learner's spoken English, not of reading. If the sound changes the word into a different word that makes sense, and you cannot tell which was meant, count it.
	Names (Ling, Jun, Mei) read in any reasonable way	
	Reading the British spelling as written ("tyres", "colour")	

When you are not sure, give the student the benefit of the doubt and write what they said on the Reading front sheet. Patterns (for example missing -ed endings throughout, or pinyin letter values such as "i" read as in pinyin) are useful evidence for the English profile.

3. Understanding (the meaning check)

After each level the student reads with **3 or more points**, ask the meaning question for that level (printed in Section 5), at the pace described in Section 1. Read the question aloud once and let the student answer in their own words. Mark ✓ (understood), **½** (partly) or ✗ (not understood) on the Reading front sheet. The answer must be in English: one word or a short phrase is enough, and pointing to the right words in the sentence also counts. An answer in Chinese is marked ✗.

4. Fluency

Rate the student's reading on the **last level they read with 4 or more points**, and write the rating on the Reading front sheet.

Rating	What it sounds like
1	Word by word. Long pauses. Little sense of the sentence as a whole.
2	Mostly two- or three-word groups, with some word-by-word reading. Little expression.
3	Mostly in sensible phrases. Some pauses to work out harder words. The sentence makes sense to the listener.
4	Smooth and phrased, close to natural speech, with stress and expression that show understanding.

5. Interviewer's copy of the sentences

The student reads from the card (`Sentence_Reading_Card`). Follow this copy as they read, and write the points (2, 1 or 0 for each sentence), the meaning mark and the level total on the **Reading front sheet** (`forms/Reading_Front_Sheet`).

No.	Sentence (Level 1)
1	I can see a red bus.
2	The cat sat on my bed.
3	Dad has a big hat.
	Meaning (sentence 2): "Where did the cat sit?" *Accept: On the bed, on my bed.*

No.	Sentence (Level 2)
4	We went to the shop to get some milk.
5	The frog jumped out of the pond.
6	They like to play in the park.
	Meaning (sentence 4): "What did they go to the shop to get?" *Accept: Milk.*

No.	Sentence (Level 3)
7	Ling put on her coat because it was cold outside.
8	The little boat floated slowly down the river.
9	Grandma made noodles for everyone at the party.
	Meaning (sentence 7): "Why did Ling put on her coat?" *Accept: Because it was cold (outside).*

No.	Sentence (Level 4)
10	After school, Jun and his friends played football on the green field.
11	The children could hear the water splashing against the rocks.
12	Most people carry an umbrella when the clouds turn grey.
	Meaning (sentence 11): "What could the children hear?" *Accept: Water splashing (on the rocks), the sea or river hitting the rocks.*

No.	Sentence (Level 5)
13	Mei was surprised to find a tiny kitten hiding behind the library door.
14	Before the long journey, Dad checked that the tyres had enough air.
15	The strange noise in the kitchen turned out to be a hungry mouse.
	Meaning (sentence 14): "What did Dad check before the journey?" *Accept: The tyres; that the tyres had enough air.*

No.	Sentence (Level 6)
16	Although the mountain path was difficult, the whole class reached the top before noon.
17	The museum guide explained how early people made tools from stone and bone.
18	My favourite season is autumn, when the leaves change colour and the air feels fresh.
	Meaning (sentence 18): "What happens to the leaves in autumn?" *Accept: They change colour (accept: they turn red, yellow or brown).*

No.	Sentence (Level 7)
19	The weather forecast warned that the temperature would drop sharply during the night.
20	Our neighbour immediately recognised the voice on the telephone and smiled.
21	The community worked together to clean the river and protect the local environment.
	Meaning (sentence 19): "What did the weather forecast say?" *Accept: It will get much colder at night; the temperature will go down a lot.*

No.	Sentence (Level 8)
22	The scientists collected evidence carefully before they announced the results of their experiment.
23	A queue of excited passengers waited patiently on the platform for the delayed train.
24	The ancient bridge, which was built from enormous stones, has survived for centuries.
	Meaning (sentence 23): "Why were the passengers waiting?" *Accept: Their train was late (delayed).*

No.	Sentence (Level 9)
25	The orchestra rehearsed for several weeks to perfect the rhythm of the challenging final movement.
26	Volunteers distributed warm blankets and hot drinks to the runners who had finished the marathon.
27	Although the explanation seemed reasonable, the detective suspected that the witness was not telling the truth.
	Meaning (sentence 27): "What did the detective think about the witness?" *Accept: The witness was lying, or not telling the whole truth.*

No.	Sentence (Level 10)
28	The architect's design was praised for combining traditional courtyards with sustainable, energy-saving technology.
29	Researchers are investigating whether the mysterious behaviour of the birds is caused by changes in climate.
30	The committee unanimously agreed that the proposal was too expensive and would require further consideration.
	Meaning (sentence 29): "What are the researchers trying to find out?" *Accept: Whether climate change is the reason the birds behave strangely.*

No.	Sentence (Level 11)
31	The psychologist's analysis suggested that the athlete's anxiety was caused by an unconscious fear of failure.
32	Meticulous archaeologists spent months excavating the tomb, revealing exquisite pottery and bronze ornaments.
33	The government's ambitious infrastructure programme has transformed transport links between rural and urban regions.
	Meaning (sentence 32): "What did the archaeologists find?" *Accept: Beautiful (very fine) pottery and bronze ornaments, in a tomb.*

No.	Sentence (Level 12)
34	The connoisseur's idiosyncratic taste baffled the gallery owner, who had anticipated a more conventional choice.
35	Despite the ostensibly benign forecast, the meteorologist remained sceptical and recommended a thorough reassessment.
36	The philosopher's paradoxical aphorisms were considered unfathomable by most of her contemporaries.
	Meaning (sentence 35): "How did the meteorologist feel about the forecast?" *Accept: Did not believe it, doubted it, wanted it checked again.*

6. Reading age

Total points = points scored + 6 for every level below the basal level that was not read.

Reading age (years:months) = 5:00 + 2 months for every point (0 points: below 5:00). So 6 points = 6:00 (Level 1 secure), 12 points = 7:00, 30 points = 10:00, 60 points = 15:00, 72 points = 17:00 (the ceiling: report "16 years or above" for 66 points or more).

Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age	Points	Reading age
1	5:02	13	7:02	25	9:02	37	11:02	49	13:02	61	15:02
2	5:04	14	7:04	26	9:04	38	11:04	50	13:04	62	15:04
3	5:06	15	7:06	27	9:06	39	11:06	51	13:06	63	15:06
4	5:08	16	7:08	28	9:08	40	11:08	52	13:08	64	15:08
5	5:10	17	7:10	29	9:10	41	11:10	53	13:10	65	15:10
6	6:00	18	8:00	30	10:00	42	12:00	54	14:00	66	16:00
7	6:02	19	8:02	31	10:02	43	12:02	55	14:02	67	16:02
8	6:04	20	8:04	32	10:04	44	12:04	56	14:04	68	16:04
9	6:06	21	8:06	33	10:06	45	12:06	57	14:06	69	16:06
10	6:08	22	8:08	34	10:08	46	12:08	58	14:08	70	16:08
11	6:10	23	8:10	35	10:10	47	12:10	59	14:10	71	16:10
12	7:00	24	9:00	36	11:00	48	13:00	60	15:00	72	17:00

Write on the Reading front sheet: total points, reading age, actual age (years:months), the difference (reading age minus actual age), meaning checks (levels asked, how many ✓) and fluency rating (1 to 4).

7. What the result means

This screen is not standardised. The reading ages come from the way the sentences were built (how common the words are, the spelling patterns in the English National Curriculum word lists for each year, and the length and structure of the sentences). Treat a reading age as a range of about 6 months either side. Once 30 to 50 students have taken it, compare their reading ages with the reading paper and with how they get on in class, and adjust the guide below if needed.

The reading band. In Years 1 to 3 the reading band comes from the Early Reading Screen; in Years 4 to 10 from the reading paper. This screen confirms the band. Use the table as a guide; if this screen and the main reading result differ by more than one band, look for the reason (below).

Reading age compared with actual age	Years 3 to 5	Years 6 to 10
At or above actual age, or close below it	up to 6 months below: **E**	up to 12 months below: **E**
Below	7 to 12 months below: **D**	13 to 24 months below: **D**
Well below	13 to 24 months below: **C**	25 to 42 months below: **C**
Far below	25 to 36 months below: **B**	43 to 60 months below: **B**
Very far below, or Level 1 not secure	more than 36 months below: **A**	more than 60 months below: **A**

- **Years 1 and 2.** Many fluent English speakers score 0 to 6 points at the start of Year 1. At the start of Year 2 a fluent reader usually has Level 1 secure and often Level 2. Use the reading age as supporting evidence only.
- **Decoding ahead of understanding.** If the meaning checks on the last two levels read are mostly ✗, move the band down one. This is common for students who learnt phonics or the phonetic alphabet well but have a small English vocabulary: they can "say" words they do not know.
- **Understanding ahead of decoding.** A student who understands well (✓ throughout) but stops early on long, rare words may be a confident English user who has had little reading practice, or may have a specific difficulty with reading. Look at the Early Reading Screen or the reading paper and, if there is a pattern, raise it in the summary.
- **Low fluency** (rating 1 or 2) with a good reading age often means effortful decoding: the student will find long texts in English tiring at first.
- **Level 1 not secure** at any age: use the letter sounds and Section 1 words of the Early Reading Screen to find what the student knows.

Write on the Reading front sheet: the indicative band, and one line on patterns noticed.